Cleveland Clinic

INTERNATIONAL & EMERGING MARKETS | ADVISORY OFFERING PROFILE

Technology Infrastructure, Interoperability & Cybersecurity

A resilient, secure and vendor-neutral technology backbone where clinical and business systems share data by default and care keeps running through cyber incidents and downtime.

CATEGORY	TYPICAL DURATION	DELIVERY MODEL
Digital & Technology Advisory	6 to 16 weeks	Virtual, Hybrid, Workshop-based

01 CLIENT NEED

New and existing hospitals struggle with how to host, connect and protect a growing set of systems: EHR, ERP, imaging, call center, CRM and local vendor solutions. Key questions include building versus renting data center capacity, what must stay on site for resilience, and how to integrate systems without costly rework. Hospitals are also prime targets for cyberattacks, and an outage can halt clinical operations, so security, data residency, consent and access controls must be designed in from day one and downtime and recovery plans must be tested.

Requests usually come from the CIO, CISO, IT leadership, compliance or executive leadership, triggered by EHR selection, data center planning, a new build, integration problems in an existing environment, a regulatory requirement, a security incident or a board-level risk review.

02 CLEVELAND CLINIC VALUE PROPOSITION

Cleveland Clinic designs, builds and activates technology infrastructure for its own new facilities using a standard Global Design for enterprise platforms (EHR, ERP, HRIS) and dedicated infrastructure, network and telecom delivery teams. It also integrates cybersecurity architecture, vulnerability remediation and annual testing into its own implementation programs.

Clients benefit from lessons learned on hosting models, integration sequencing, security by design, and downtime and business continuity planning, the foundational decisions that are hardest to reverse later. Advice is vendor-neutral and grounded in standards-based interoperability (HL7/FHIR).

03 KEY DELIVERABLES

- Current-state architecture and application landscape review
- Hosting and data center option assessment (build, rent, hybrid)
- Integration and interoperability approach (HL7/FHIR)
- Application rationalization recommendations (existing hospitals)
- IT guideline and standards documents
- Security posture and policy review
- Security-by-design recommendations (identity, access, data residency, consent)
- Downtime, backup and business continuity plan review
- Cyber incident tabletop exercise (optional)
- Prioritized risk mitigation recommendations

04 DELIVERY MODEL

Virtual / Hybrid / Workshop-based

Remote architecture, document and security posture review, including a posture questionnaire, followed by virtual working sessions with Cleveland Clinic architecture, infrastructure and cybersecurity experts and written option papers and recommendations. Optional in-person sessions include a technical deep-dive or data center walkthrough for high-stakes decisions, and a tabletop cyber incident simulation that tests the client's response and downtime procedures.

05 TYPICAL DURATION

6 to 16 weeks

Phase 1 Current-state architecture, security posture and policy review; Phase 2 Option analysis and working sessions; Phase 3 Recommendations, guideline package and risk mitigation plan; optional tabletop exercise. Security-focused scopes typically run 6 to 12 weeks and full architecture and infrastructure scopes 8 to 16 weeks.

06 RESOURCE REQUIREMENTS

CLEVELAND CLINIC TEAM

- International & Emerging Markets engagement lead
- Enterprise or solution architect
- Infrastructure and network SME
- Cybersecurity SME
- Infrastructure and business continuity SME as needed

CLIENT TEAM AND INPUTS

- Executive sponsor (CIO, CISO or IT director)
- Architecture, application and integration inventory
- Data center and hosting plans
- Security policies and controls
- Downtime and business continuity plans
- IT team time, with IT and clinical operations representatives

07 EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- Clear decisions on hosting model and integration approach
- Reduced risk of costly, hard-to-reverse infrastructure choices
- Standards-based foundation that supports future growth and multi-site scale
- Clear view of security gaps and priorities
- Security and privacy controls designed in from day one
- Tested downtime and continuity procedures
- Reduced risk of care disruption from cyber events